GENERATIVE AD CREATIVE · 2025 – 2026

Adroom

Ad teams could buy media in minutes but waited weeks for the ads themselves. I designed the studio that closes that gap, from brief to on-brand, launch-ready creative.

ROLE

Senior Product Designer

TEAM

3 product designers

SCOPE

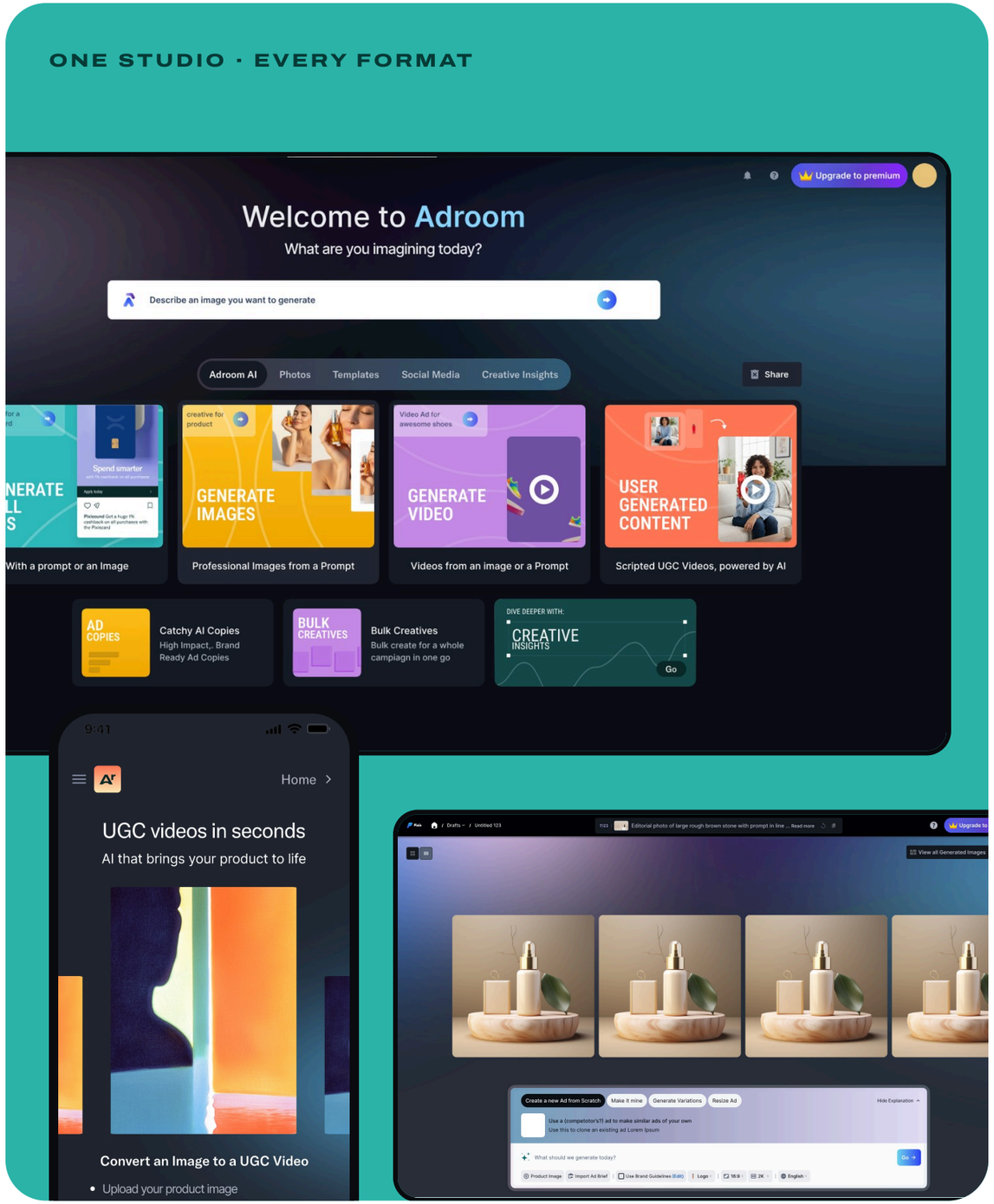
Research, UX & UI, design system, handoff

PLATFORM

Web app + mobile

OUTCOME

87% faster creative turnaround*



*Pixis-reported, 2026.

Everyone agreed creative mattered. Almost no one could keep up.

Targeting and bidding had been automated, so the ad itself now decided most of the result. Yet the creative still moved through briefs, designers, resizes and sign-offs one file at a time.

SURVEY OF US MARKETERS MANAGING $5M+ IN AD SPEND

say creative matters for performance **89.2%**

say it is well understood and optimized **3.6%**

EMARKETER, Feb 2026 (n = 111).

BRIEF → LIVE AD, THE TRADITIONAL WAY

8 – 12 weeks

for a multi-format campaign. Most of it is not design work but waiting: briefs in queues, files moved between tools, reviewers who haven't looked yet.

41%

of teams need **3 – 4 weeks** to get a finished asset live.

Smartly, 2026

41%

only hear how a creative performed **2 – 4 weeks after launch**.

EMARKETER, 2026

~5%

of creatives become real winners. You need volume to find them.

Motion, 578,750 creatives

HOW I GOT UNDER THE PROBLEM

Before designing screens, I mapped where the weeks go.

01 · THE PRODUCTION CHAIN, END TO END

Brief	Concept	Copy & design	Resize per placement	Brand check	Sign-off	Upload	Learn
strategy, goals	angles, references	first version	every format, by hand	caught by eye	up to five layers	manual, per platform	2 – 4 weeks later

Mechanical steps, where most of the time is lost Time sinks: briefs waiting in a queue · files moved between tools · reviewers who haven't looked yet

02 · COMPETITIVE TEARDOWN

6

tools compared on seven jobs

Pencil, Canva, Adobe Firefly, HeyGen, Kling and Runway, on brand control, scale, formats, video, review, launch and learning.

03 · THE PRECEDENT

60k

creatives in six weeks for Swiggy

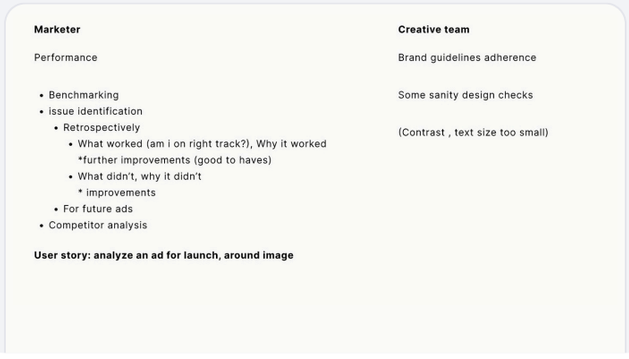
Pixis's earlier creative engine proved variation at scale works when the client's own team approves the output. Adroom had to keep that control.

Swiggy case study, Pixis

04 · FIRST-USE MAPPING

Two audiences, two definitions of a good result.

Marketers: what worked and why. Creative teams: is it on brand, is the text readable.



Every tool solved one step.

Generators made images. Editors made layouts. Video tools made clips. None of them carried a brand from the first prompt to a live, reviewed ad.

THE GAP I DESIGNED FOR

Brand-safe production at volume, with review built in, in one place.

Last row: Ad launch was the remaining gap, so I designed a publish flow to Meta.

	BRAND RULES ENFORCED	BULK / CATALOG	MULTI-FORMAT	VIDEO / UGC	REVIEW FLOW	PUBLISH TO ADS	LEARNS FROM RESULTS
Pencil	◐	−	·	✓	✓	✓	✓
Canva	◐	−	◐	−	·	−	−
Adobe Firefly	−	−	−	✓	−	−	−
HeyGen	·	·	·	✓	·	·	·
Kling	·	·	·	✓	·	·	·
Runway	◐	·	·	✓	·	·	·
Adroom	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

✓ strength − stated gap ◐ partial · not covered ✓ designed to close the gap

Canva

A brand kit stores assets but doesn't teach the AI how the brand behaves across formats.

Firefly

Commercially safe images can still be entirely off-brand.

Pencil

Generation caps of 50 – 250 put a ceiling on catalog-scale work.

Based on public 2026 product comparisons.

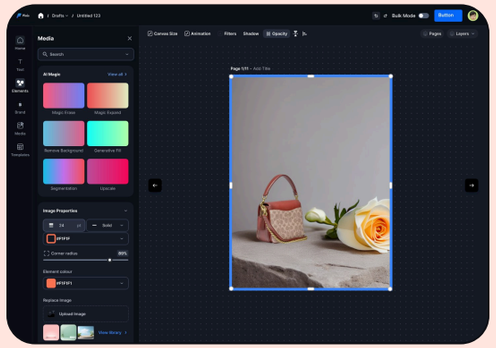
Four insights shaped the product.

01

The time goes to waiting, not making.

Most of the 8 – 12 weeks is handoffs: **briefs in queues, files moved between tools, sign-offs in layers.**

Designers spend their days resizing, not designing.



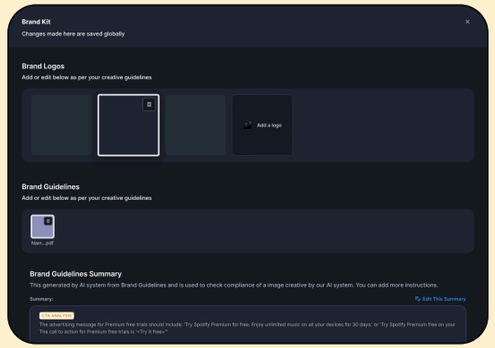
SO ADROOM

keeps every step in one studio, with no export and re-import between tools.

02

Volume is where brands drift.

A small team can hold a brand in its head. At hundreds of variants, **the review queue grows faster than anyone can clear it,** and the brand book sits unread in a shared drive.



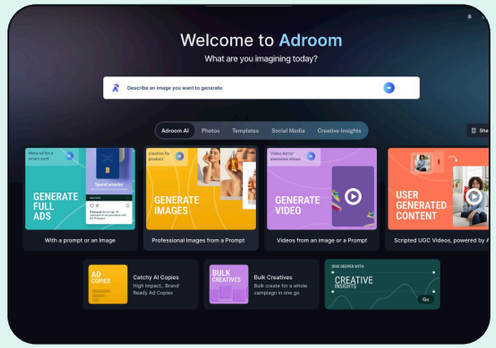
SO ADROOM

takes the brand in before generation, not after.

03

Marketers ask for outcomes, not tools.

In my first-use mapping, marketers wanted **"what worked, and why"** and a next ad. Nobody arrives wanting segmentation or a background remover.



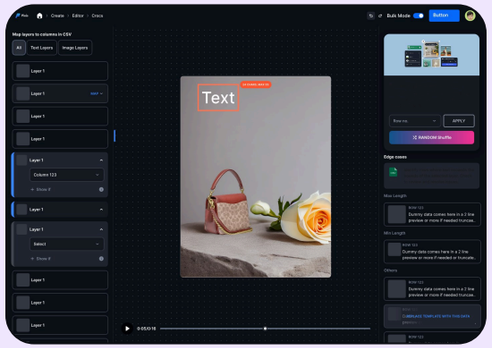
SO ADROOM

starts from the thing you want to ship: a full ad, an image, a video, a UGC clip.

04

At scale, a surprise is expensive.

Only about **1 in 20 creatives wins,** so teams generate in bulk. One bad row of data can quietly break hundreds of ads.



SO ADROOM

shows what will break before it generates anything.

From insights to a path, one round at a time.

01
Explore
Rough flows for generation, editing and home. Wide on purpose.

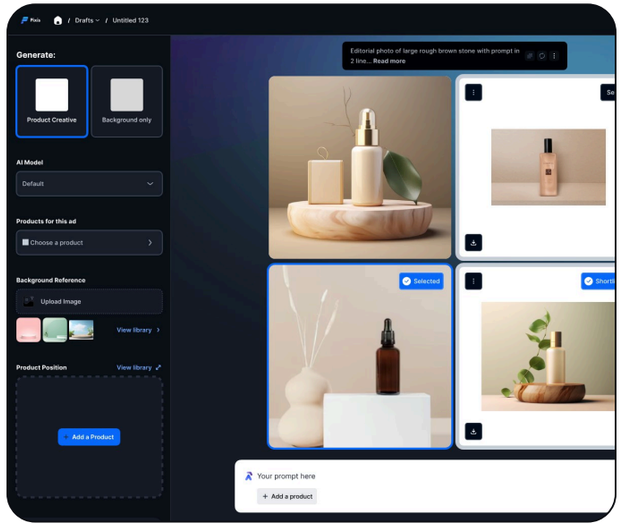
02
Structure
Big tiles for outcomes, small tiles for tools. Written down before drawn.

03
Low-fi
Wireframes for insights: score first, then summary and three actions.

04
Iterate
Home re-sorted three times. Generation rebuilt around one prompt.

05
Harden
Errors, empty states and loaders for every flow.

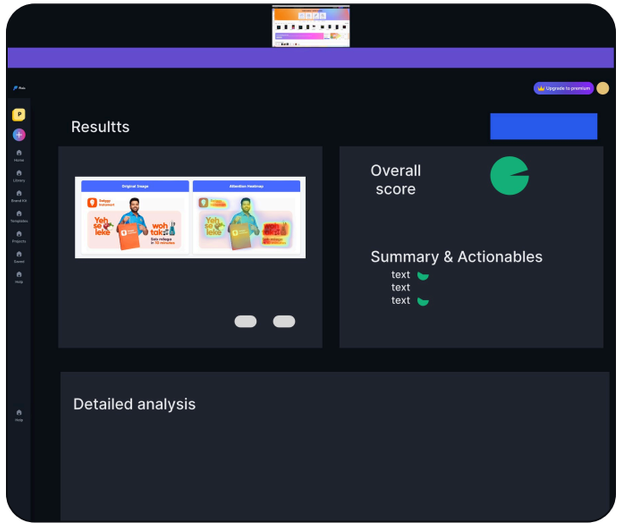
06
Hand off & revise
Token specs and dev notes, then a V2 pass in Feb 2026.



Explore: the first generation screen, a panel of settings.



Structure: my first-use notes.



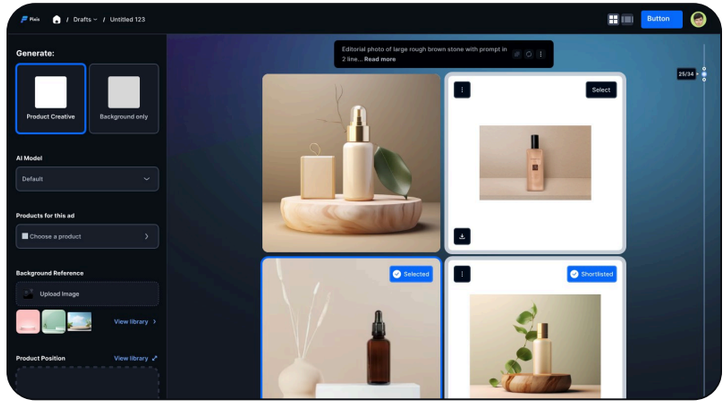
Low-fi: creative insights results.



Counted from the final Figma file.

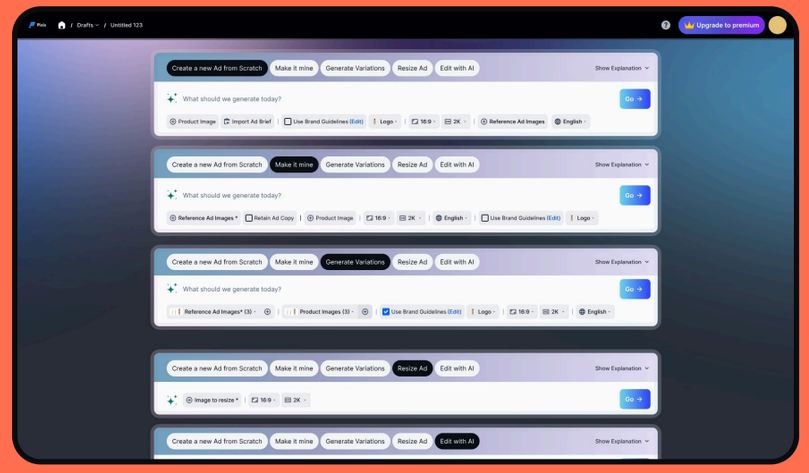
Two rebuilds that changed the product.

GENERATION · FROM SETTINGS TO INTENT



ROUND 1

A left panel of settings: creative type, products, background reference, model, product position. Powerful, but you had to configure before you could create.

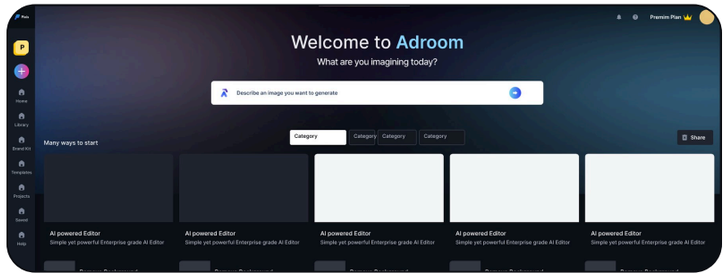


FINAL

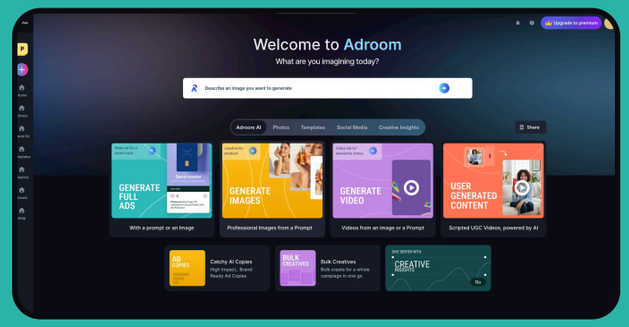
One prompt bar, five intents.

Create from scratch, make it mine, variations, resize, edit. Each intent shows only the inputs it needs. Settings moved behind the prompt, not in front of it.

HOME · RE-SORTED THREE TIMES



Round 1: a grid of individual tools.



FINAL

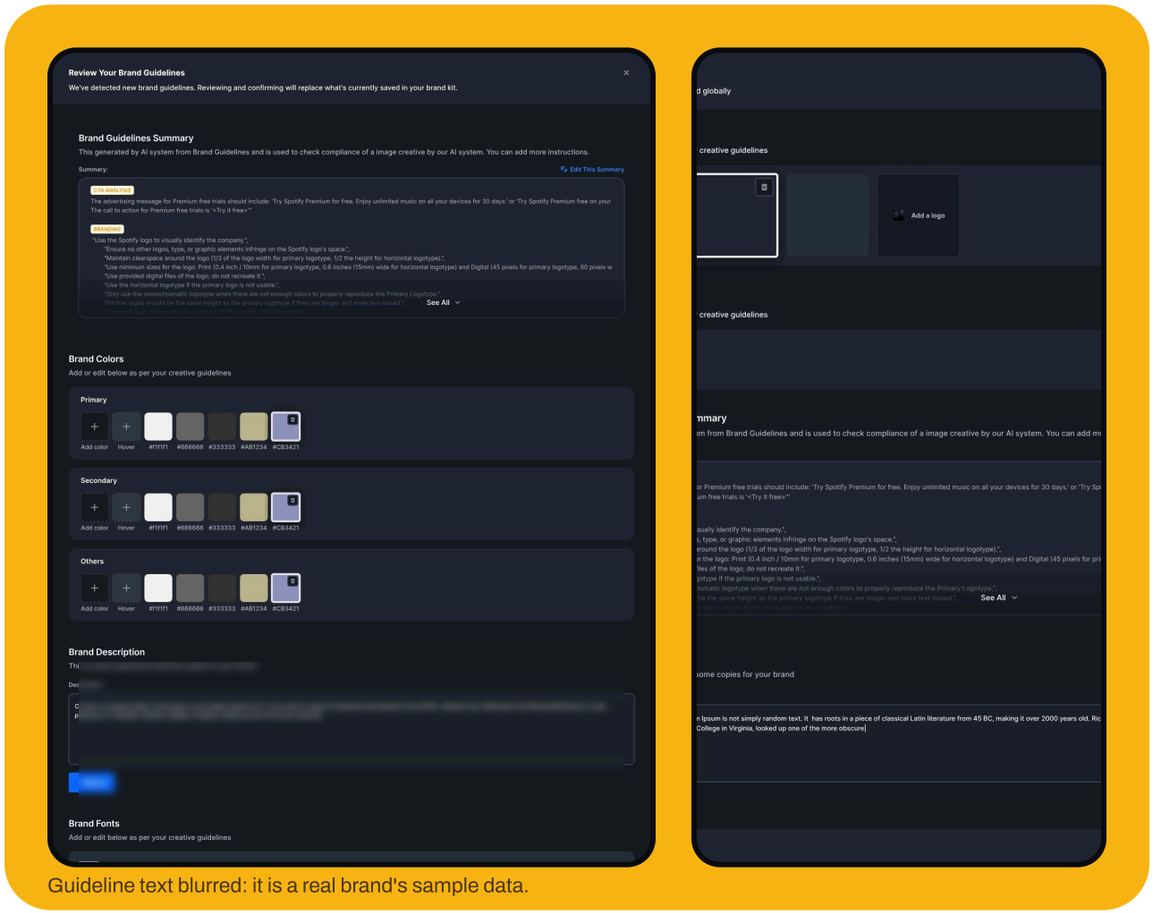
Four outcomes, tools as shortcuts.

Full ads, images, video and UGC up top, named the way marketers ask. Copy, bulk and insights as small tiles; editing tools live in the editor.

BRAND BEFORE GENERATION

The brand book goes in first.

Upload the guidelines PDF once. Adroom drafts the rules, you edit them, and the same rules check every creative and apply colours, logos and fonts in the editor.

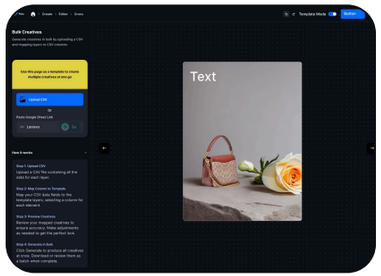


Guideline text blurred: it is a real brand's sample data.

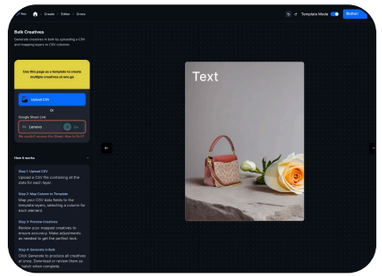
NO SURPRISES AT SCALE

See what breaks before it ships.

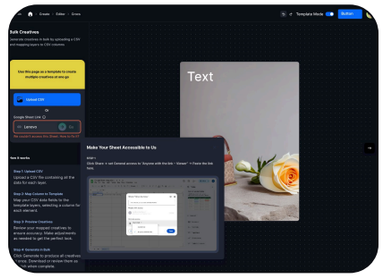
Bulk mode turns a template and a sheet into a campaign. I designed it to explain each step up front and to flag the exact rows that will break a layout.



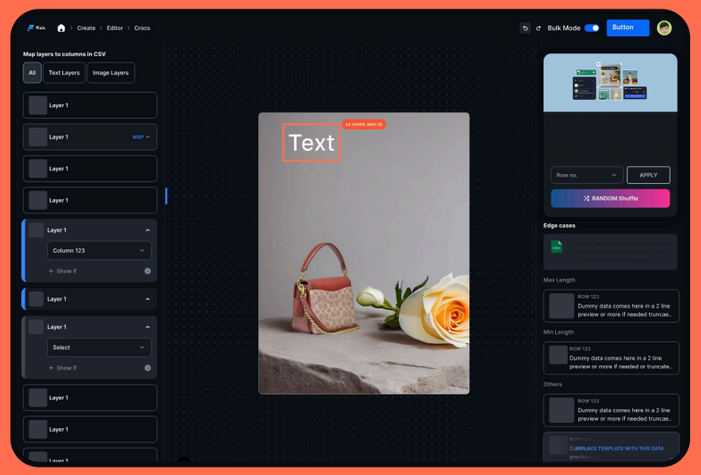
1 · Steps explained up front



2 · Sheet not shared? Say so



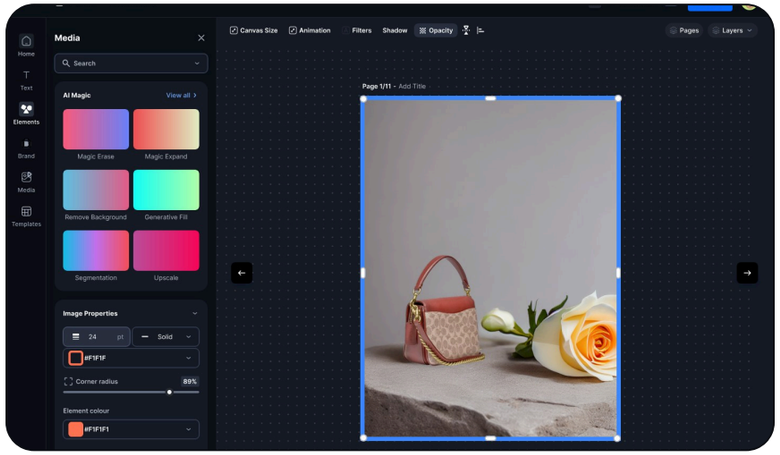
3 · Show how to fix it



Edge cases before you generate

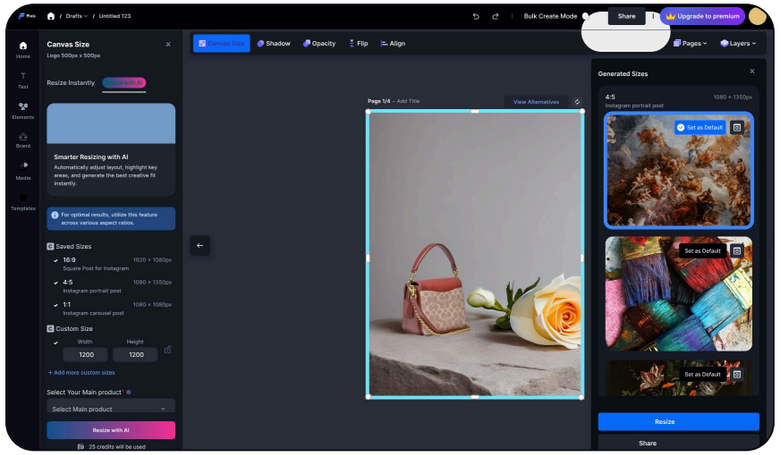
The longest and shortest value per layer, and the row numbers that break the design.

One studio, brief to launch.



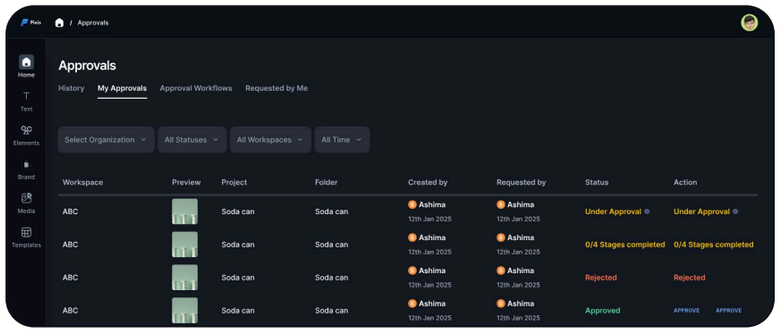
AI tools inside a real editor

Erase, expand, remove background, fill, segment, upscale.



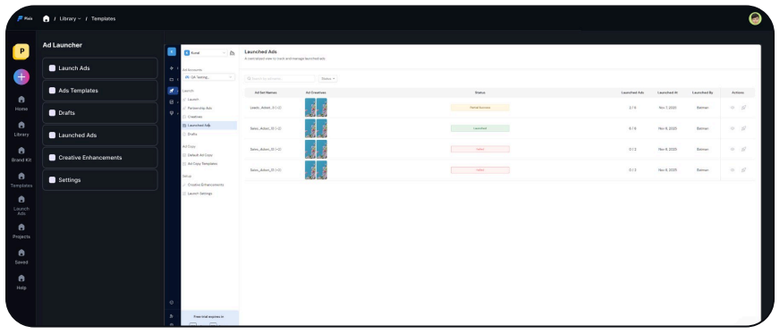
Smarter resizing

16:9, 4:5, 1:1 from one design, filling edges instead of cropping.



Review rounds

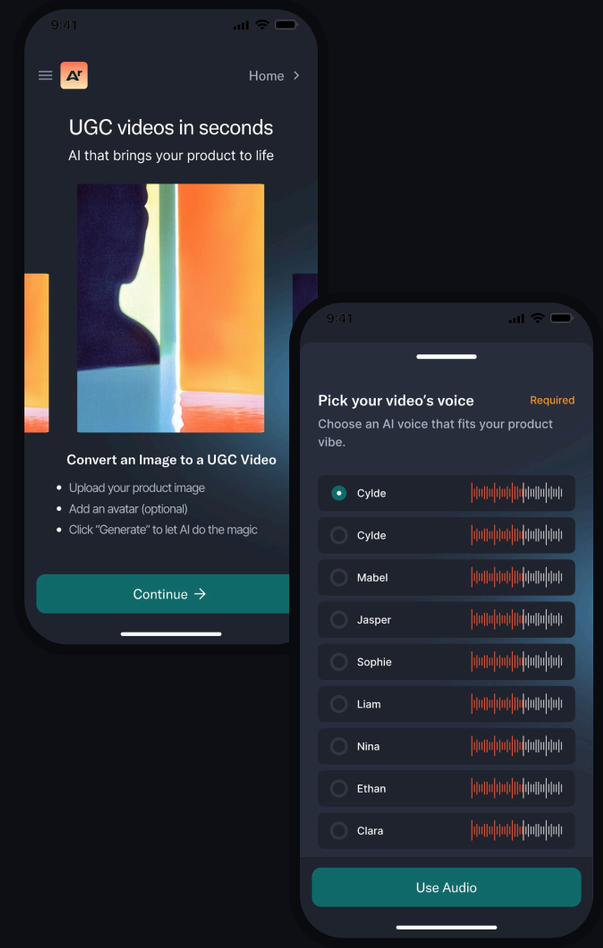
Approvers and rounds per workspace, the control Swiggy's team relied on.



Ad launch

Publish to Meta from the studio, the last gap in the chain.

MOBILE · UGC VIDEO FROM ONE PHOTO



A deliberately limited mobile experience: pick a product, write a script, choose a voice. The full editor stays on desktop.

Faster to ship. Better at converting.

87%

faster creative turnaround*

+28%

average lift in ROAS*

~700

screens across web and mobile

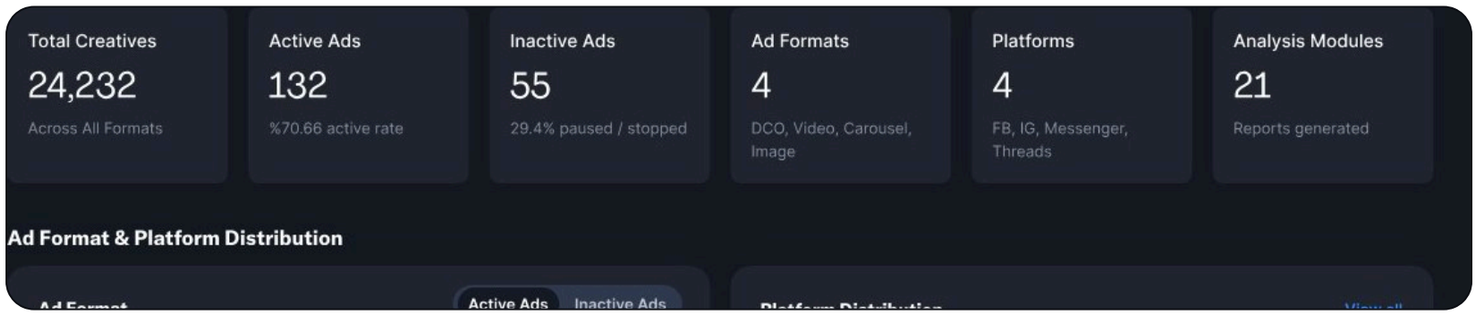
4 formats

1:1 · 4:5 · 9:16 · 16:9 from one design

17 signals

per competitor report on Meta ads

COMPETITOR INSIGHTS REPORT



*Pixis-reported, 2026.

IF I DID IT AGAIN

Talk to users earlier and more often.

Market data told me where the weeks go. Sitting with creative teams sooner would have shortened the three rounds on home.

WHAT I LEARNED

Name outcomes, not tools.

Marketers ask for a video ad, not for segmentation. Home got simpler the moment it spoke their language.

Intent beats settings.

A prompt that knows the job is a faster start than a panel you have to configure first.

Guardrails make speed safe.

Brand rules and row-level checks are why teams trust a batch they did not design ad by ad.

Design the wait.

When a job takes minutes, progress is the experience. No blank white screens, transitions under half a second.

FUTURE SCOPE

Show why a variant won.

Make performance learnings visible inside the studio, so designers see why a variant won, not just that it did.